

companies dealing with LED lighting solutions. Stephan Greiner, Vice President, Global Sales of Everlight Electronics Co. Ltd. was forthright in the advantages of sourcing components from Taiwan. He was excited too at the high quality standards of Taiwanese products when compared to other low cost models. He reiterated the sentiment shared by many we met in Taiwan, "the quality of products in Taiwan is superior at low prices." In fact, Everlight has used Taiwanese designs for one of the lamps it plans to introduce in the market. The leaning towards LEDs was evident all across the event, and in a country that has a controlling stake in global affairs, whether you are talking about lighting or green technologies, it won't be long before you mention Taiwan.

Smart tags

RF identification is also, a rather underutilised technology in India, again something we need to learn from Taiwan. When we drive through our highways, and stop over at toll checkpoints, it reminds us of our time spent in Taiwan, where unmanned toll booths would directly transact with your vehicle as you drive through without any need to decelerate, leave alone stop your vehicle. In fact even the retail industry depends on RFID tagging to track goods being sold, and managing inventory.

We don't see that happening in the stores around us. Who says foreign investment is bad for the Indian retail

industry? What would we prefer, a few individuals growing richer by the day or increased transparency?

Security measures

Moving over RFID, Mifare and newer technologies are now finding their way in to the industry. Several Taiwanese companies, including Soyal Technology Co. Ltd., showed us their latest range of security products. These include locks, safes and also fingerprint and finger-vein scanning devices. Similar to fingerprints, latest security devices now use finger-vein patterns to draw a unique pattern for each user registered with the system. The chances of forging and duplicating finger-vein patterns are much lower than fingerprints.

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Innovation

The number of available products were enormous. We saw paper thin LEDs



Each visitor was tagged, making use of technologies showcased at the event

sewn to bags that you could fix on your bicycles. Although road rules aren't as stringent in India, the world over cyclists need to have a light indicating they are stopping. With inventions such as these, cyclists don't even have to do any fixing or fitting with their bicycles. We saw camera set-ups that capture vivid colour images even in extreme dark conditions; and even found intelligent power meters that cater to prepaid energy distribution networks. Another new product being promoted was the MEMS microphone. MEMS stands for MicroElectrical-Mechanical System. These kind of microphones are minuscule and are etched directly on to silicon chips.

Another area we were pleased to explore was Web TV. Richard Chen, Product Marketing Manager for Webia Technologies gave us a demo of an effective alternative to Google TV. A box, much cheaper than \$100 running on Android would guide you through TV, email, chat, games and more. We're waiting for them to be sold in India. As for IPTV, they still haven't made a mark in India.

The Indian market

When we asked for their opinion on the Indian prospects, nearly everyone agreed to India being a "low cost" and "price critical" market. It's a perception globally that we tend to focus on products that are cheap, rather than emphasise on quality. Sad, really. We're looking forward to the day when consumers in India are considered discerning and choosy, rather than bargain hunters. It was comforting, however, when most of the companies said they were watching India closely...



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